On 21 June 2016, Modi joined 30,000 fellow citizens in a mass session of yoga in the heart of New Delhi.[6] Interestingly, Modi's supporters cited the global prevalence of yoga and the ease with which the United Nations adopted an international day for yoga as a sign of India's arrival on the world stage as a major global power. Conventional definitions of what it means to be a great power would differ with this view. Increasing number of people practising the ancient regimen of yoga has little to do with the current influence of the Indian state around the world. Similarly, being a champion of anti-colonialism, a leading voice amongst the post-colonial developing countries, having been one of the founders of the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM), or even a prominent voice in multilateral institutions like the United Nations may give India global recognition and pride but it is hardly a substitute for hard power.

Many Indians believe their country has economic power, military strength and an important geostrategic location. To them, that alone should be enough for global power status coupled with India's 5000-year-old civilization. However, in a recent book provocatively titled *Why India Is Not A Great Power? (Yet)*, leading Indian strategist Bharat Karnad asserts that India does not fulfil the requirements of global power status, at least at the present moment. Karnad maintains that to be a great power a country needs 'a driving vision', a sense of 'national destiny', defining of 'national interests', and 'willingness to use coercion and force in support of national interests' along with 'imaginative' use of both hard and soft power.[7] India is several steps short of that position.

That Indians believe that the popularity of yoga is evidence of India's importance in the world explains how India views itself from a very different perspective than other nations. Indian leaders often suggest that the more India participates in multilateral organizations, adopts principled stands on global issues, champions global peace and disarmament and speaks out against military alliances, the higher the pedestal it occupies on